

The Double Procession of the Holy Spirit in Joachim of Fiore's Understanding of History

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Since the composition of the *Expositio super Hieremiam* in the 1240s, Joachim's disciples as well as many scholars less sympathetic to him have been fascinated by his vision of a third *status*, identified with the Holy Spirit, surpassing or even superseding the *status* of the Father and that of the Son.* By unanimous agreement the three *status* are the historical expression of the relationships within the three persons of the trinity. Consequently, it is impossible to understand Joachim's historical patterns without discussing his theology. The controversies about the one inevitably affect the other.

In 1215 the Fourth Lateran Council upheld the trinitarian doctrine of Peter Lombard and condemned Joachim's polemical treatise, the *De unitate seu de essentia trinitatis*. No complete manuscript of the *De unitate* has been found, and, therefore, Joachim's arguments against Peter Lombard must be reconstructed from the conciliar decree and from a few scattered passages in his other books. Joachim accused Peter of separating the essence or unity from the persons and thus of making God into a "quaternity." The council and most later theologians have, however, criticized Joachim. Antonio Crocco has demonstrated that Joachim's confessional statements are irreproachably orthodox but, like the Greek Fathers, Joachim approached the

* This article represents a substantial revision of a paper which under a different title was presented at the American Society of Church History meeting in Washington, D.C., December, 1976. It is an outgrowth of my work on an edition of the *Liber de concordia noui ac veteris testamenti*, for the financial support of which I am indebted to grants from the American Philosophical Society and the University of Kentucky Research Foundation. The following abbreviations of Joachim's works are used in the notes of this article:

- Exp. *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, Venice, 1527; reprinted Frankfurt a. M., 1964.
- L. C. *Liber de concordia noui ac veteris testamenti*, Venice, 1519; reprinted Frankfurt a. M., 1964.
- L. F. *Liber figurarum. Il libro delle figure di Gioacchino da Fiore*. Edited by L. Tondelli, M. Reeves, and B. Hirsch-Reich, 2nd rev. ed., 2 vols. Turin, 1953. (The edition of the text and the plates are in vol. 2.)
- L. I. *Liber introductorius in Apocalypsim*, Venice, 1527; reprinted Frankfurt a. M., 1964.
- Ps. *Psalterium decem chordarum*. Venice, 1527; reprinted Frankfurt a. M., 1964.
- T. E. *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia*. Edited by E. Buonaiuti. Fonti per la storia d'Italia 67. Rome, 1930.

Trinity from the standpoint of the three distinct but inseparable persons and did not satisfactorily reconcile their threeness with their unity.¹

This assessment of Joachim's trinitarian doctrine appeared to parallel exactly his three *status*. The abbot was not a tritheist, but he emphasized the distinction of the Holy Spirit from the other two persons, especially from the Son. While those scholars who wanted to defend his orthodoxy have tried to avoid the full implications of this correlation — the view that the clerical church of the second *status* with its scripture, sacraments, and papacy would be supplanted by the monastic church of the third *status* — the logic of the argument has favored the more radical interpreters. Just as the Greek and Latin churches have supplanted the synagogue, so they should be replaced by the spiritual church. Three distinct divine persons meant three successive historical *status*, belonging in order to the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit should enjoy his own distinct *status* in his turn.²

Although these scholars were aware of other patterns of history used by Joachim, they had generally ignored them. The traditional views were, therefore, substantially jarred by Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich's studies of the *Liber figurarum*, which demonstrated conclusively that Joachim divides history not only into the three *status* but also into two *tempora*, from Adam to Christ and from Christ to the end of history. Marjorie Reeves has shown convincingly that this twofold pattern plays a major role in Joachim's understanding of history. Because it makes Christ and, therefore, the papal church endure from the Incarnation until the end of

¹ The pioneer work was Paul Fournier, *Etudes sur Joachim de Flore et ses doctrines* (Paris, 1909; rep. Frankfurt a. M., 1963). A survey of earlier work on Joachim can be found in Morton Bloomfield, "Joachim of Flora: A Critical Survey of his Canon, Teachings, Sources, Biography, and Influence," *Traditio* 13 (1956), 249–311 (reprinted in Delno West, *Joachim of Fiore in Christian Thought*, 2 vols. [New York, 1975], 2:29–91). The most extensive treatment of Joachim's trinitarian doctrine recently is Antonio Crocco, *Gioacchino da Fiore* (Napoli, 1960). Crocco defends the orthodoxy of Joachim, whereas Stephan Otto, *Die Funktion des Bildbegriffes in der Theologie des 12. Jahrhunderts*, Beiträge zur Geschichte der Philosophie und Theologie des Mittelalters 40, Heft 1 (Münster, Westf., 1963), pp. 292–309, criticizes Joachim's use of analogy. Otto reiterated his views in his "Bonaventuras christologischer Einwand gegen die Geschichtslehre des Joachim von Fiore," *Miscellanea Mediaevalia*, 11: *Die Mächte des Guten und Bösen*, ed. Albert Zimmermann (Berlin, New York, 1977), pp. 113–130, where he also criticizes Joachim on Christological grounds. Anneliese Maier in "Zu einigen Handschriften der Biblioteca Alessandrina in Rom und ihrer Geschichte," *Revista di Storia della Chiesa in Italia* 18 (1964), 1–12, announced her discovery of some leaves from a manuscript of the *De unitate* (see Herbert Grundmann, "Lex et Sacramentum bei Joachim von Fiore," *Miscellanea Mediaevalia*, 6: *Lex et Sacramentum im Mittelalter*, ed. Paul Wilpert [Berlin, 1969], pp. 31–48, esp. p. 33).

² On earlier views see Bloomfield, "Critical Survey," pp. 260–271 (pp. 40–51), esp. n. 80. Herbert Grundmann in "Lex et Sacramentum" qualified his former radical views, particularly with respect to the role of the sacraments in the third *status*. Crocco, *Gioacchino da Fiore*, ably represents the defenders of Joachim's orthodoxy (see pp. 85–101). Otto, *Die Funktion* and "Bonaventuras christologischer Einwand," takes the radical interpretation for granted. The impressive study by Henry Mottu of the *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia*, entitled *La manifestation de l'Esprit selon Joachim de Fiore* (Neuchâtel, Paris, 1977), also defends the radical view but with some significant qualifications, especially on Joachim's Christology (pp. 326–328).

history, it is quite orthodox. Simultaneously it seems irreconcilable with the division into three *status*. In order to explain this apparent contradiction, Prof. Reeves has suggested that the twofold pattern was intended to be institutional, while the threefold tended to be "mystical," "a new quality of life rather than a new set of institutions." Professor Reeves has proven that any interpretation of Joachim must be able to account for both schemata. In effect she has established a new starting point for studies of Joachim.³

The thesis of this article can be stated briefly: The double procession of the Holy Spirit is the central clue needed to comprehend both of Joachim's schemes of history. From this standpoint both divisions of history appear in a new light, the threefold as the unfolding of relationships between the three orders (the married, the clergy, and the monks), the twofold as the development from the two peoples, Jewish and Gentile, of the *spirituales viri*. To Prof. Reeves the two patterns appeared to be contrasting alternatives. In the light of the double procession, however, they become complements. Indeed, they are two halves of a single whole. Neither can be understood without the other.

Before entering into the defense of this thesis, a discussion of terminology is necessary. Hitherto this article has referred to Joachim's threefold scheme or the division of history into three *status*. Joachim himself called this schemata the *prima diffinitio*, which he represented figuratively by the triangular letter alpha (A). Joachim described the twofold pattern as the *secunda diffinitio*, symbolized by the letter omega (ω), in which "Joachim saw the middle stroke, the virgula, as representing a third part issuing from the two parts of the figure."⁴ Since Joachim's terminology more accurately describes

³ Marjorie Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages* (Oxford, 1969), pp. 16–29. M. Reeves and B. Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore* (Oxford, 1972), pp. 1–19. M. Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore and the Prophetic Future*, pb. ed. (New York, 1977), pp. 5–22. While this article disagrees with her interpretation of the relationships between these two patterns, I should like to acknowledge my profound debt to the work of Prof. Reeves, whose studies have undoubtedly given us not only a new foundation for the interpretation of Joachim but also an enormous amount of information, especially on the role of the *figurae* in his thought and works.

⁴ Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, pp. 6–7; L. C., Book 2, Tract. 1, chap. 9, fol. 10rb: "Prima diffinitio designatur in .A. quod est elementum triangulatum. Secunda designatur in .ω. in quo virgula de medio duarum procedit. Utrumque ergo sciri oportuit quia utrumque plenarie pertinent ad catholicam fidem." In the manuscripts this is properly set aside as a separate chapter. The bulk of Book 2 of the *Liber de concordia* is taken up by a detailed treatment of the *prima diffinitio*. In Book 2, Tract. 2, chap. 9 fol. 23rb–va, Joachim turns to a discussion of the *secunda diffinitio* which continues to the end of Book 2. Here Joachim writes: "Nunc autem locus est ut agamus de mysterio quod continetur in .ω. secundum quod duo sunt testamenta ex quibus unus intellectus spiritualis procedit. Oportet autem nos iterum incipere ab Adam et ab Ozia, rege Iuda, quatinus ex duobus parietibus una tela texatur" (fol. 23va). Joachim next discusses the seven seals and their openings in Book 3 before returning to the *secunda diffinitio* in his treatment of the *generalis concordia*, in Book 4, chaps. 1–32. In chapters 33–40 of Book 4 he comes back to the *prima diffinitio*. Implicit in this article is the thesis that the first four books of the *Liber de concordia* are Joachim's major systematic treatment of his two *diffinitiones* as well as of the seven seals and their openings (the series of sevens). Joachim, therefore, meant these four books to be the *prolegomena* to the commentary on the Old Testament (Book 5 of the *Liber de*

the two schemes than the labels threefold and twofold, it will be used in the remainder of this article.

In his surviving works, Joachim rarely refers to his dispute with Peter Lombard. He refers incessantly, however, to the Latin addition of *filioque* to the Nicene Creed and the consequent dispute with the Greeks. Joachim was one of the leading Latin abbots in Calabria in the last two decades of the twelfth century, where the schism between Rome and Constantinople was a potent political, ecclesiastical, and theological issue. On the matter of the double procession of the Holy Spirit, Joachim strongly defended the Latin position. Although he was aware of other matters of dispute between the Latin and Greek Christians, the *filioque* was the crucial one in his opinion.

In light of the close relationship between the Trinity and history in Joachim's thought, the double procession ought to play a significant role in his patterns of history, yet the voluminous scholarship scarcely alludes to it and the established interpretations of the *prima diffinitio* take no account of it. Here indeed is a classic example of the deceptive operation of the "red herring." The condemnation of 1215, the lost *De unitate*, and the apparent correlation with the three *status* have drawn the attention of historians and theologians from the *filioque* and centered their efforts on the controversy with Peter Lombard.

The significance of the double procession of the Holy Spirit for the *prima diffinitio* is summarized in the following passage from the *Liber de concordia*. In the text printed at Venice in 1519 it reads:

Quia uero unus est Pater a quo procedunt Filius et Spiritus Sanctus, unus Spiritus qui a Patre simul procedit et Filio, duo qui procedunt ab uno Patre, recte primus status ascribitur Patri, secundus soli Filio, tertius communis Filio et Spiritui Sancto.⁵

The reading of the printed text is supported by only one manuscript, Vat. Lat. 3821, an extensively annotated fifteenth-century copy. All of the remaining manuscripts have a substantially different reading:

Quia uero unus est Pater a quo procedunt Filius et Spiritus Sanctus, unus Spiritus qui a Patre simul procedit et Filio, duo qui procedunt ab uno Patre, recte primus status ascribitur soli Patri, tertius Spiritui Sancto, secundus autem communiter Filio et Spiritui Sancto.⁶

concordia) and the New Testament (The *Expositio in apocalypsim* and the *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia*). These books are then the key to these other portions of Joachim's principal works. Among previous scholars, only Prof. Reeves has attempted to analyze them in any detail and she is concerned chiefly with the *figurae* (see *The Figurae*, pp. 20-24; 29-38). In the introduction to my edition, I intend to explore the structure of these four books more intensively. The two *diffinitiones* are also explained in *tavolae* XI a and b of the *Liber figurarum*, the figure of the trinitarian circles, where there are drawings of the alpha and the omega. In his commentary on Apocalypse 1.8, Joachim deals with the alpha and the omega but also with the omicron, which respectively symbolize the three equal persons, the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Father and Son, and the unity of the three persons (Exp., Part 1, fols. 33vb-38vb).

⁵ L. C., Book 2, Tract. 1, chap. 8, fol. 9vb.

⁶ Vat. Lat. 4861, fol. 17vb. Some manuscripts read "tertius soli Spiritui Sancto." For a list of

The version found in Vat. Lat. 3821 and the Venetian edition are the result of an intentional alteration designed to reverse the meaning of the original passage. Joachim meant to say that the first and third *status* should be ascribed to the Father and to the Holy Spirit respectively, the second both to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.

Taken out of its context this passage in its original form seems radical, diluting the *status* of the Son and emphasizing boldly that of the Holy Spirit, but understood in its proper setting, the meaning is different. Here Joachim is fulfilling a promise which he had made earlier in Book Two to discuss the relationship between the three orders, the married, the clergy, and the monks.⁷ Whereas the *ordo coniugatorum* began with Adam and the *ordo clericorum* in the generation of Uzziah, king of Judah, the *ordo monachorum* had a double *initiatio*, according to its proper form ("secundum quam propriam formam") from St. Benedict of Nursia, but according to a certain likeness ("secundum quam similitudinem") from the prophet Elisha.

For thus the entire multitude of believers is considered by God to be like one man who is made of flesh, of blood, and of the breath of life. For as blood is the intermediary between flesh and soul, thus the order of the clergy is the intermediary between the married and the monks. The order of the married bears, therefore, the image of the Father, because, just as he is the Father because he has a Son, thus the married order was established by God only for the purpose of bearing sons. . . . The order of the clergy bears the image of the Son, who is the Word of the Father, because it was constituted in order that it should preach and teach the way of the Lord to the people and show them continuously the legitimate rules of their God. The order of monks bears the image of the Holy Spirit, who is the love of God, because this order could not despise the world and mundane things unless it was provoked by the love of God and impelled by the same Spirit which expelled the Lord into the desert, whence it is called spiritual because it walks not according to the flesh but according to the Spirit.⁸

the manuscripts of the *Liber de concordia* see Reeves, *The Influence*, Appendix A, p. 512. In addition to those listed there, for this chapter I have collated Vat. Lat. 4860; Vat. Lat. 5732; Florence, Bibl. Laur., Plut. XXVIII, dextr. xi; Rome, Vat. Arch. Cap. S. Petri, D205; Valencia, Bibl. Univ. n. 1205. Below, the Venetian text reads: "Igitur primus status attribuendus est Patri, secundus Filio, tertius Spiritui Sancto, pro eo enim quod in tertio statu ostensurus erat Spiritus Sanctus gloriam suam." Vat. Lat. 4861, fols. 17vb–18ra, reads: "Igitur primus status attribuendus est Patri, secundus Filio et Spiritui Sancto, quamvis clariora sint in eo quia sic oportuit opera attributa Filio, tertius Spiritui Sancto, pro eo enim quod in tertio statu ostensurus erat Spiritus Sanctus gloriam suam." Of the manuscripts only Vat. Lat. 3821 omits "et Spiritui Sancto . . . attributa Filio." See also: Exp., Pt. 1, fol. 93rb, commenting on Apoc. 3.14: "Diximus enim pertinere secundum statum secundum ea que significat ad Filium et Spiritum Sanctum, licet magis proprie ad Filium qui et aperte operatus est in eo, statum uero tertium proprie ad Spiritum Sanctum"; T. E., p. 23: "Inde est ut cum aliquid typice volumus exponere in scripturis, primo occurrat nobis quasi processio Spiritus Sancti a Patre, secundum quam similitudo Patris tenenda est in primo statu seculi, similitudo Spiritus Sancti in secundo, deinde quasi processio Spiritus Sancti a Filio, secundum quam similitudo Filii tenenda est in secundo statu, similitudo Spiritus Sancti in tertio"; Ps., fol. 253va: "Pro eo enim quod Spiritus Sanctus procedit a Patre oportuit secundum statum habere contemplatores sicut et doctores. Quid sicut ordo doctorum proprietate mysterii pertinet ad Christum, ita ordo contemplantium ad Spiritum Sanctum."

⁷ L. C., Book 2, Tract. 1, chap. 5, fol. 8va–vb.

⁸ Ibid., chap. 8, fol. 9va: "Ita enim extimanda est apud deum uniuersa multitudo credentium

The first *status*, that of the Father, belongs to the married. The second, which is common to both the Son and the Holy Spirit, belongs to the clergy and the monks. The *status* of the Holy Spirit belongs to the monks. The three *status* are, therefore, the historical unfolding of the relationships between the married, whose function is procreation; the clergy, who proclaim the Word; and the monks, who embody the spiritual bond of love. To understand these *status* as historical epochs in the modern sense is misleading, because a period of history as we understand it includes all aspects of life within its chronological and spatial boundaries, whereas Joachim is concerned only with the relationships between these orders. At the same time the *status* involve different institutional relationships between the orders as well as new and higher levels of Christian life.

From the beginning of the *ordo coniugatorum* onward, the orders evolve progressively toward the final goal. This evolution is nothing less than the historical realization among the orders of the relationships between the persons of the Trinity. The goal is the actualization of a society in which the orders mirror the Trinity itself.

For Joachim, historical fact confirmed the Latin position on the *filioque* against the Greek. He accepted the double initiation of the monastic order. This could only be possible if the Holy Spirit proceeded from both the Father and the Son. If the Holy Spirit had proceeded only from the Father, then the clergy and the monks should have had a simultaneous *initiatio* and *consumatio*. If the Spirit had proceeded only from the Son, then the *initiatio* of the monks should have been from Benedict alone. Only the double *processio* could account for the double *initiatio*.

The second *status* is ascribed both to the Son and to the Holy Spirit (*communiter*). The works of the Son — the proclamation of the Word by means of the Incarnation and the clergy — overshadow those of the Spirit. The Spirit was revealed first to Mary, then at the baptism of Christ, next to those baptized in Christ, and lastly at Pentecost, but these “children” or “little ones” were not prepared to absorb the *spiritualis intellectus*. The principal role, therefore, had to belong to the visible Christ who humbled himself by becoming man. After his resurrection the clergy continued his ministry, functioning thus as his order.⁹

ac si unus homo qui constat ex carne et sanguine et spiraculo uite. Sicut enim sanguis medius est inter carnem et animam, ita ordo clericorum medius est inter coniugatos et monachos. Habet ergo coniugatorum ordo imaginem Patris, quia sicut Pater, ideo Pater est quia habet Filium, ita ordo coniugatorum non nisi ad procreandos filios institutus est a deo. . . . Habet et clericorum ordo imaginem Filii qui est verbum Patris quia ad hoc constitutus est et ipse ut loquatur et doceat populum uiam Domini et ostendat ei continue legitima dei sui. Habet et monachorum ordo imaginem Spiritus Sancti qui est amor dei, quia non posset ordo ipse despicere mundum et ea que sunt mundi nisi provocatus amore dei et tractus ab eodem Spiritu qui expulsiit Dominum in desertum, unde et spiritualis dictus est quia non secundum carnem ambulat sed secundum spiritum.” This passage immediately follows a quotation of Eph. 4.13. See below pp. 475–476.

⁹ See above, n. 6. See also L. I., chap. 10, fol. 12rb–va; chap. 19, fols. 18va–19rb; chap. 24, fol. 22vb.

Only when the goal had been attained and the Christian people were prepared by means of the monastic order could the Spirit reveal his own glory. The third *status* is ascribed to the Holy Spirit and to the monastic order. This appears to mean that only they will attain the goal. After the end of the second *status* only monks would remain. This, however, is not what Joachim envisioned in the third *status*. As was noted above, he believed that God viewed the three orders as one man made of flesh, blood, and the breath of life. Joachim defined the goal by citing Paul. The three orders must evolve until they become "the image and likeness of the Trinity so that at last all shall come together in the unity of the faith, into mature manhood according to the measure of the fullness of Christ."¹⁰

The goal of Joachim's *prima diffinitio* is to build the Body of Christ, to realize the *pleroma*.¹¹ This will be achieved only in the third *status*, which, therefore, is the *status* of the fullness of Christ (*plenitudo Christi*).¹² Although Joachim ascribes this third *status* to the Holy Spirit alone, nevertheless, there seems to be a Christological element there. Ephesians 4.13 is cited again by Joachim in Book Five of the *Liber de concordia*, where he combines Paul's metaphor of the Body of Christ with Christ's statement: "In my father's house are many mansions" (John 14.2). Seven mansions are envisioned in which the laity, differing levels of monks, regular canons, and probably prelates will dwell.¹³ Both Grundmann and Reeves believe that this text from

¹⁰ Eph. 4.13. See L. C., Book 2, Tract. 1, chap. 8. fol. 9va.

¹¹ Cf. the remarks of Joseph A. Grau, *Morality and the Human Future in the Thought of Teilhard de Chardin* (Rutherford, N.J., 1976), who describes the thought of Teilhard in a similar vein: "According to St. John and St. Paul, he affirms that the fulfillment of every creature, in development, determination, and personality cannot be found except in Christ Jesus. Everything in the cosmos for the spirit, and everything spiritual for Christ, are his order of progression. For Teilhard, a thoroughly Christian orientation for a morality of effort and development can be derived from the revealed imperative to build the Body of Christ, to achieve the *Pleroma*" (p. 309).

¹² Ernst Benz, *Evolution and Christian Hope*, trans. by Heinz G. Frank (New York, 1968), locates Joachim in the development of a theology of evolution, but treats Joachim as presenting a radical pneumatology. Crocco, *Gioacchino da Fiore*, pp. 100–101, defends the pleromatic and Christological aspect of the third status. Mottu, *La manifestation*, treats Joachim's Christology at some length, arguing that it tends to be kenotic and exemplaristic, in other words emphasizing the self-emptying humiliation of Christ in the Incarnation and the role of Jesus as a model, but deemphasizing the ultimate glorification of Christ (pp. 189–193). Mottu also recognizes the role of the *pleroma*, the fullness of the body of Christ, but suggests that despite his use of Eph. 4.13 in the third *status*, "... la première initiative de Dieu par le Fils est relayée, dans l'histoire, par une seconde initiative spirituelle plus forte et plus durable. Il s'agit donc bien d'une seconde initiative d'une 'nouvelle initiative historique' comme nous avons cru pouvoir la caractériser, qui s'ordonne à la christologie selon un rapport tantôt symbolique, où le Christ selon son humanité devient le 'type' de l'Esprit: *Spiritus sancti typus* . . ." (pp. 283–85, 326–27). Jesus, therefore, is considered more as prefiguring the Spirit than the Spirit is seen as fulfilling Christ. In this respect, the procession of the Spirit from the Son, about which Mottu has little to say, seems crucial, implying that the Spirit reveals and fulfills the incarnation of Christ.

¹³ L. C., Book 5, Part 1, chap. 22, fol. 71r–v; Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, pp. 238–239; H. Grundmann, *Neue Forschungen über Joachim von Fiore* (Marburg, 1950), pp. 88–90, n. 1.

the *Liber de concordia* is the basis of the figure which is entitled *Dispositio novi ordinis pertinens ad tertium statum*. At the left top of this figure, Joachim quotes 1 Corinthians 12.14-20, the other Pauline exposition of the Body of Christ, which begins: "For the body does not consist of one member but of many." Beneath this text, Ephesians 4.7-8 and 11-13 appear again. On the top right, Joachim quotes the Johannine vision of the *sedes dei* from Apocalypse 4.1-7. In the *Dispositio* itself, seven *ordines* are arranged in oratories spatially ordered so as to form either St. John's future Jerusalem — a four-square pattern with additional suburbs — or a cross with a pedestal and predella. Both the clergy and the laity are expressly included. Joachim is driving home his notion that the goal of history is the achievement of the fullness of Christ, that unity within which diverse members, having varied spiritual gifts, live as one body. Herbert Grundmann contended that this *Dispositio* represents the transition period between the second and third *status*, rather than the final *status* itself. His most convincing argument is that Joachim is usually wary of making precise statements about the third *status*. Marjorie Reeves's view that the *Dispositio* belongs to the third *status* itself is clearly preferable. Grundmann believed that the third *status* would belong to the monks alone, but Joachim's notion of unity and diversity within the Body of Christ demands the inclusion of both clergy and laity.¹⁴

Joachim is able to ascribe the third *status* to the Holy Spirit and at the same time envision it as the realization of the mystical Body of Christ, because for Joachim the third *status* is the historical expression of the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Son. The *prima diffinitio* is symbolized by the letter alpha, drawn with a blunted top that stands for the Father, while the left-hand line represents the sending of the Son, the right-hand line the procession of the Holy Spirit. Thus "two are sent from one," while "one remains unsent." The double procession appears conspicuously absent from this symbol. Nevertheless, the third *status* demands the procession of the Spirit from the Son. Furthermore, Joachim clearly envisions this *diffinitio* as an expression of the double procession:

In this *diffinitio* of the sacred name according to which we call IE the Father, EU the Son, and UE the Holy Spirit, it is shown that there are three persons in the godhead and that these persons are indivisible and inseparable from each other, and that the Son is from the Father alone, which the Greeks confess with us, and that the Spirit proceeds from the Son, which the Greeks deny.

This note accompanies the figure of alpha, in which the blunted top bears the first two letters of the tetragrammaton, IE; the left-hand bottom, the middle letters, EU; and the right bottom, the final two letters, UE. Because the letter of the Spirit, E, appears in both the IE and EU, while the U — the

¹⁴ L. F., tav. xii; Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, pp. 232-248; Grundmann, *Neue Forschungen*, pp. 85-121, esp. 111-112.

symbol of the Son — appears also in the UE, Joachim can consider this a satisfactory exposition of the generation of the Son from the Father and of the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Son as well as from the Father.¹⁵

The problem lies in the letter alpha itself, which lacks a line connecting the two bottom ends. Joachim clearly understands the left-hand and right-hand lines as depicting the generation of the Son and the procession of the Spirit from the Father respectively. A line across the bottom would equally represent the procession of the Spirit from the Son, but the alpha has no such line. Nevertheless, Joachim clearly is thinking of such a line when he describes the alpha as an *elementum triangulatum*. Joachim, therefore, is thinking in fact of an isosceles triangle in which the top angle represents the Father, the lower left the Son and the lower right the Holy Spirit. This expresses the equality of the three persons but also the intra-trinitarian relationships. The division of the letters of the tetragrammaton suggest this hypothetical triangle. The *figura* of the psalter with ten strings which is for Joachim the supreme expression of the Trinity contains just such a bottom line and, despite its blunted top, is for Joachim triangular.¹⁶ The *prima diffinitio* is a pattern in which one is not sent but two are sent, in other words in which two are sent from one. It is also a pattern in which one is sent by two. The first *status* belongs to the Father. In the second *status* the Father sends the Son and Holy Spirit both, the former in visible, the latter in invisible form. In the third *status* the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Son. The *processio* of the Holy Spirit from the Son explains Joachim's insistence on the *plenitudo Christi* as the ultimate aim of the third *status*. The particular spatial arrangements of the *Dispositio noui ordinis* may be only a suggestion, not a fixed plan, but the combination of laity, clergy, and monks is essential to the third *status*. The *pleroma* is the unity of the diverse. Joachim never envisioned the monks alone without the other two orders.

The *secunda diffinitio*, characterized by the letter omega (ω), divides history into two *tempora*, the first of which began its initial phase with Adam and reached its maturity (*fructificatio*) with Jacob. The *initiatio* of the second *tempus* commenced with Josiah, thus overlapping with the final phase of the first *tempus*. The *fructificatio* of the second *tempus* began with Christ, and this *tempus* will endure until the end of history itself. It is thus parallel chronologically with Augustine's sixth *etas*, the period between the coming of Christ in humility and his final coming in glory. It is apparent that these two *tempora* correspond closely to the first and second *status* of the *prima diffinitio* up to the forty-second generation after the Incarnation, but then the second *tem-*

¹⁵ L. F., tav. XI a and XI b: "In hac diffinitione sacri nominis qua dicimus IE Patrem, EU Filium, UE Spiritum Sanctum ostenditur quod tres sunt persone deitatis et quod ipse persone indivisibiles sunt et inaccessibiles a seipsis et quod Filius sit a Patre solo quod Greci confitentur nobiscum et quod Spiritus procedat a Filio, quod Greci negant." See Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, pp. 38–58, 194–196; Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, pp. 6–7.

¹⁶ L. F., tav. XIII; Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, pp. 55–61, 199–201.

pus simply continues, and Joachim makes no mention of a parallel for the third *status*.¹⁷

As has been shown above, in the three *status* Joachim worked out the relationship between the three orders. Similarly in the two *tempora* of the *secunda diffinitio* Joachim is concerned with the relationships between two peoples, the Jewish and the Gentile. He traces the origin of the *populus Iudaicus* to Adam, who introduced corruption into Israel. From Jacob onward God showed mercy to the Jewish people. In the *Liber de concordia* Joachim derives the *populus Gentilis* from Romulus and Remus, whom Joachim placed in the same generation with Josiah. The Gentiles received mercy from the time of Christ onward.

The key element in this *secunda diffinitio* is, however, the *spirituales viri*, who originate from both these peoples. Joachim equates these spiritual men with the monks. Thus during the time of the Jewish people, the *spirituales viri* include Elijah, Elisha, and the sons of the prophets. In the Gentile *tempus* the spiritual men include both Benedictine monks and Greek monks, or at least some of the latter.

The *secunda diffinitio* also has an exegetical dimension. The first *tempus* is that of the Old Testament, the second that of the New Testament. From these two testaments the *spiritualis intellectus* proceeds. Just as the Old Testament was committed to Israel, the New to the Church, so the spiritual understanding is given to the *spirituales viri*.¹⁸

The duration of the second *tempus* from the Incarnation until the end of history makes the *secunda diffinitio* appear to be routinely orthodox and creates, at the least, a seemingly sharp contrast with the *prima diffinitio*, especially with the third *status*, that of the Holy Spirit. Just as, however, the *prima diffinitio* on deeper examination can be shown to be less acutely radical, so careful attention to the *secunda* indicates that it is not as conventional as it seems at first sight. In the *prima diffinitio* the goal of history is the *plenitudo Christi*, the fullness of Christ's mystical body, but this will be realized only in the third *status*, which is the historical actualization of the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Son. In the *secunda diffinitio* the *spirituales viri* and the *spiritualis intellectus* proceed from and are, therefore, the goal of the two *tempora*. Joachim distinguished the two *diffinitiones* when he asserted that in the *prima* the subject was the good works of God and that in the *secunda* the theme would be God's just judgments. The two *tempora* are then divided into two series of six judgments each. The last two Old Testament persecutions come together in the same generation, because, according to Joachim, the fall of Babylon and Haman's persecution occurred in the time of Zerubabel. Similarly, in the New Testament the fall of the "New Babylon" and the appearance "of a certain great tyrant whom many will believe to be

¹⁷ See above, n. 4; L. C., Book 2, Tract 1, chap. 7. fol. 9ra-rb; Book 2, Tract. 1, chap. 9, fol. 10rb.

¹⁸ L. C., Book 2, Tract 1, chap. 7, fol. 9ra-rb; L. I., chap. 6, fols. 6rb-9ra; Exp., Part 1 (on Apoc. 1.8), fol. 37ra-vb.

antichrist" will occur in one generation. The generations after Zerubbabel and those after this "antichrist" will be sabbaths. The New Testament sabbath will last until the end of history. Clearly Joachim expects the full realization of the *spirituales viri* and the *spiritualis intellectus* to be attained only in this final era of rest and contemplation. In the *secunda diffinitio* the whole thrust of history surges toward this goal.¹⁹

The spiritual aim of the *secunda diffinitio* is even more clear when the two *tempora* are examined as expressions of the double procession of the Holy Spirit. The symbol of the *secunda diffinitio* is the letter omega (ω) "in which one rod (virgula) proceeds from the middle of two." If the alpha's lines suggest that two are sent from one, the omega clearly represents for Joachim the procession of one from two, i.e., the double procession of the Holy Spirit from the Father and from the Son. In the trinitarian circles, Joachim employs the tetragrammaton again to make his point. I is designated Father and placed on the left side, while U stands for the Son on the right. The vertical middle bar is marked on both sides at the top by E, which designates the Holy Spirit.

In this *diffinitio* of the sacred name by which we call the Father I, the Holy Spirit E, the Son U, and the Holy Spirit E, it is shown that the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father and that this same Spirit proceeds from the Son and that this one Spirit has cooperated with the Father, who worked particularly in the Old Testament, and that in the New he has cooperated with the Son, who said: "My Father worked up until now and I work."²⁰

The emergence of the *spirituales viri* with Elijah in the Old Testament *tempus* and of the Benedictine monks in the New Testament period as well as the parallel development of the *spiritualis intellectus* are the historical manifestation of the double procession of the Holy Spirit. The convergence of the two sides of the omega into the ascending middle rod suggests strongly that Joachim here envisions history moving toward a goal in which the *spirituales viri* and the *spiritualis intellectus* will be predominant.

In this *diffinitio* the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Son in the second *tempus* indicates that for Joachim the mission of the Spirit is to fulfill the promise of Christ. The key text is John 16.7, 12-15:

Nevertheless, I tell you the truth: it is to your advantage that I go away, for if I do not go away, the Counselor will not come to you; but if I go, I will send him to you. . . . I have yet many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now. When the Spirit of truth comes, he will guide you into all the truth; for he will not

¹⁹ L. C., Book 2, Tract. 2, chap. 9-10, fols. 23rb-25rb.

²⁰ L. F., tav. XI a and XI b: "In hac diffinitione sacri nominis qua dicimus .I. Patrem .E. Spiritum Sanctum .U. Filium .E. Spiritum Sanctum ostenditur quod Spiritus Sanctus procedat a Patre et quod idem ipse Spiritus procedat a Filio et quod ipse unus Spiritus cooperatus sit Patri qui operatus est specialiter in ueteri testamento et in novo cooperatus sit Filio qui dicit: 'Pater meus usque modo operatur et ego operor' " (John 5:17b). See also L. C., Book 2, Tract 1, chap. 9, fol. 10rb; Book 2, Tract 2, chap. 9, fol. 23ra-va; Exp., Part 1 (on Apoc. 1.8), fol. 37ra-vb; Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, pp. 6-7.

speak on his own authority, but whatever he hears he will speak, and he will declare to you the things that are to come. He will glorify me, for he will take what is mine and declare it to you. All that the Father has is mine; therefore I said that he will take what is mine and declare it to you.²¹

The emphasis in this instance falls on the Holy Spirit as the revealer of that spiritual understanding about which Christ had begun to teach his disciples, but the fullness of which was hidden from them by their carnal, mundane lives. Joachim took as axiomatic the traditional notion that only those monks whose holiness, rest, and dedication to contemplation had liberated them from the flesh and the world could attain genuine spiritual understanding. From this assumption, Joachim concluded that full understanding would only be possible when the Holy Spirit had completely freed Christians from the labor, suffering and troubles which had always characterized history, from the beginning of Israel through Joachim's own days, when the papacy was struggling bitterly with the Hohenstaufen emperors and the threat of Islam loomed on the horizon. History was, Joachim believed, moving toward that final liberation, that sabbath of peace and freedom when the promise of Christ to his disciples would be totally and finally fulfilled. "Now we see through a glass darkly, but then face to face."²² First had come the letter, then the letter and the spirit together. When the Spirit completely unveiled the truth, the letter would no longer be necessary. Joachim envisioned no new gospel, no third spiritual testament. Christ would send the Holy Spirit to accomplish what he himself had begun but could not in his earthly ministry finish. As the Father had sent the Spirit in the first *tempus*, so Christ would send him in the second, so that, as the one who is sent by two, he could complete the self-revelation of God within history.

Prof. Reeves has established the importance of the *secunda diffinitio*, but she views the two *diffinitiones* as alternative schemes, tending to be incompatible. Her suggested solution is to characterize the *prima* as "mystical," applying to the level or quality of life, and the *secunda* as "institutional," concerned

²¹ L. C., Book 3, Pt. 1, chap. 6, fol. 28ra; chap. 7, fol. 28vb; chap. 11, fol. 30va; chap. 12, fol. 30vb; chap. 14, fol. 31vb; chap. 14, fol. 32ra; chap. 20, fol. 37vb; chap. 21, fol. 38ra. Ps., Book 2, fols. 260ra, 273ra. Exp., Part 1, fols. 34ra (on Apoc. 1.8), 84rb (on Apoc. 3:7), 85ra, 86va. T. E., p. 9, lines 19–20; p. 177, lines 17–18; p. 199, lines 4–5; p. 292, lines 7–8. Nowhere does Joachim quote the entire text at once but various portions of it. The quotations from the *Liber de concordia* are from his treatment of the seven seals, where he comments on the *figura* of the *pavimentum* (see L. C., Book 3, Pt. 1, chap. 2, fol. 26va), the aim of which figure is to show the interrelationship of the Son and the Holy Spirit. Prof. Reeves treats this figure briefly (*Joachim of Fiore*, pp. 16–17, with B. Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, pp. 65–66), but it deserves much more detailed analysis than it has been given there or here. In the *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia* only verse 13a is cited, which leads Mottu, *La manifestation*, pp. 197–204, to argue that Joachim did not grasp that "La prophétie de l'Esprit, qui annoncera 'les choses à venir' [John 16.13b], est aussi et dans le même moment souvenir, *mémoire*, rappel du message et de l'oeuvre du Christ [John 14.26]" (p. 204). This judgment is unjust if Joachim's works are taken as an entity, if it is even justified for the *Tractatus*.

²² 1 Cor. 13.12. On Joachim's use of 1 Cor. 13.9–12 see Mottu, *La manifestation*, pp. 204–222.

with forms of order and structure. Thus Peter, as representative of the authority and power of the papacy, will endure to the end of history, but Peter, conceived as representing preaching and labor, will yield to John, who is symbolic of rest and contemplation. According to her interpretation, therefore, the papacy, clergy, and sacraments will continue in the third *status* of the Holy Spirit but will survive in a period dominated by monastic quiet and contemplation.²³

Viewed, however, from the perspective of the double procession of the Holy Spirit, the relationship between the two *diffinitiones* is strikingly different. Instead of being contrasting alternatives, they are mutually complementary. Taken by itself, either *diffinitio* is, therefore, only a fragment, because neither can be complete without the other. If one may change the analogy, the two *diffinitiones* are similar to pictures of a building taken from two different perspectives. To understand the building, one needs both photographs, and, despite differences in the two, they both represent the same structure.

Both *diffinitiones* describe history in terms of trinitarian patterns. In both the emphasis is placed on the double procession of the Holy Spirit from the Father and from the Son. In the case of the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Father, the two *diffinitiones* are identical. The first *tempus* coincides with the first *status*, the second *tempus* with the second *status* up to Joachim's present. Although the sabbath of the second *tempus* is not as prominently treated as the third *status*, nevertheless both *diffinitiones* emphasize the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Son and in both the full realization of this is still in the future. The first *diffinitio* may put more emphasis on the two being sent by one, while the second more distinctly presents the one who proceeds from two, but this is merely two slightly different images of the same trinitarian process.

Within the Trinity the generation of the Son by the Father and the procession of the Spirit from the Father and the Son are simultaneous and eternal. Within history, however, the generation of the Son from the Father and the procession of the Spirit from the Father are temporally prior to the procession of the Spirit from the Son. Thus the historical realization of the Trinity is not entirely analogous to the Trinity itself. It is precisely this setting apart of the procession of the Spirit from the Son which makes both *diffinitiones* significant, pointing as it clearly does, toward the future full realization of the body of Christ and the attainment of liberty and contemplation.

On the historical level, the two *diffinitiones* are complementary, if slightly different ways of viewing the same process. In both the evolution involves institutions and the quality of life together. In the *prima diffinitio* the em-

²³ Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy*, pp. 16-27, 129-132; Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, pp. 5-12; Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, pp. 6-8. Bernard McGinn has summarized and evaluated her views in his "Apocalypticism in the Middle Ages: An Historiographical Sketch," *Mediaeval Studies* 37 (1975), 252-286, esp. pp. 280-285.

phasis is placed on the three orders. The laity generate the clergy and the monks proceed from both laity and clergy. The three *status* represent the evolving relationships between these three orders which will culminate in the future, now only half-glimpsed Church of the third *status*, when the fullness of the mystical body of Christ will be attained. In the *secunda diffinitio* the two *tempora* represent the two peoples, Jewish and Gentile, and the two testaments, Old and New, from which have and will proceed the *spirituales viri* and the full *spiritualis intellectus* respectively. In neither *diffinitio* did Joachim think primarily in terms of historical periods or epochs. Neither *status* nor *tempus* can be understood as a block of time, complete in itself and set apart from its predecessor and successor. Joachim rather conceived of history as a set of interwoven relationships between the three orders and the two peoples with their two testaments. History in his view was a complex process within which a set of key elements evolved from their beginnings toward their goal. Like a tree or set of trees, history is organic growth from the roots, deep in the earth, upward to the crowning leaves and fruit.²⁴

Apart from Prof. Reeves, interpreters of Joachim have based themselves solely on the *prima diffinitio*. Her work on the *Liber figurarum* has demonstrated the importance of the *secunda diffinitio* and, therefore, created a new starting point for any understanding of Joachim and his vision of the future. The crux of this article is to go one step further. The two *schemata* are so closely parallel and indeed complementary that neither can be isolated from the other without fatally distorting the perspective. In effect, given this basis the questions about the exact nature of the future Church; the role of papacy, clergy, and monks; the interplay of letter and spirit; and ultimately the orthodoxy or radicalism of Joachim must be asked afresh. Nor are these the only *schemata* which must be taken into account. The seven seals and their openings, treated in book three of the *Liber de concordia*, and the pattern of *etates*, which is the structural basis of the *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, are equally necessary to grasp Joachim's vision. A building is only as strong as its foundation. To understand Joachim we still need a broader and sounder base on which to construct our interpretations.

Only this may be said now. As Joachim looked backward from his vantage point in the late twelfth century, he was convinced that a literal understanding of the promises of God was impossible. Understood *secundum carnem intellectum*, they had not been fulfilled and Joachim could not hope that they would be realized.²⁵ The history of Israel and of the church had been a series of persecutions and suffering. The promises had, therefore, to be understood in terms of their spiritual meaning. The process of history had to become the unveiling of the Holy Spirit, who, proceeding from the Father and the Son, would finally accomplish the work begun by the Father and continued by the Son. Only when the orders and peoples had received the

²⁴ On Joachim's use of the tree as a central symbol, especially in Book 2 of the *Liber de concordia* and the *Liber figurarum* see Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, pp. 24–38.

²⁵ L. C., Book 2, Tract. 1, chap. 1, fols. 5va–7rb.

full understanding of their faith in a world of harmony and concord, could the pleroma, the fullness of the mystical body of Christ be realized in a sabbath of holy rest and contemplation. In the *Liber figurarum* there is a drawing of two vines which, representing the two peoples, Jewish and Gentile, intertwine to form three circles, bearing fruit as they grow upward. At the top they flower luxuriantly in an overwhelming abundance of blossoms. In this picture Joachim has left us his vision of history.²⁶

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²⁶ L. F., tav. XXII. See also Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, pp. 170-173.